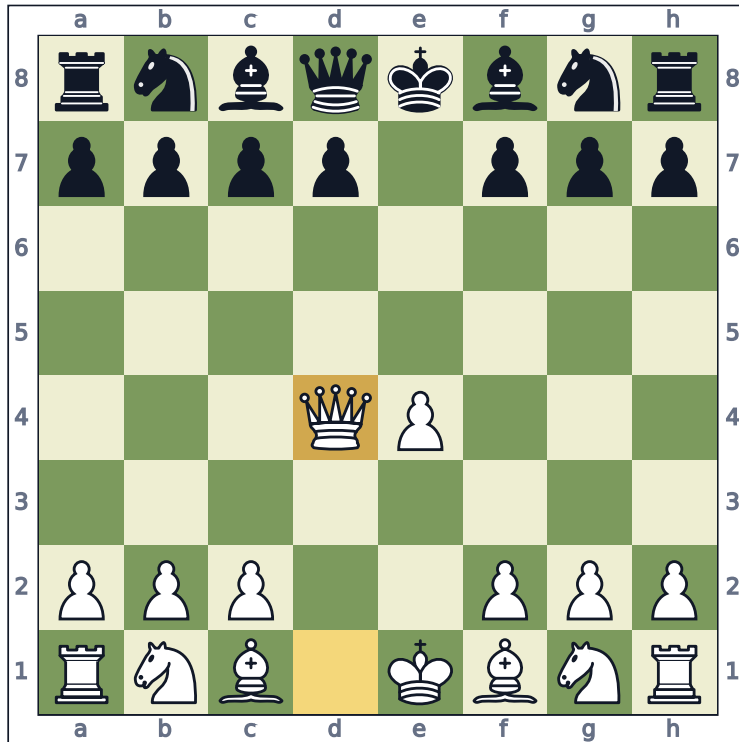


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Center Game

ECO C21 | 19 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

-0.10 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C21 covers Center Game. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Center Game.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C21 line

This section preserves all 19 names and defining routes assigned to C21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Center Game**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Qxd4

002 **Center Game Accepted**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4

003 **Center Game: Halasz-McDonnell Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. f4

004 **Center Game: Halasz-McDonnell Gambit, Crocodile Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. f4 Bc5 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. c3

005 **Center Game: Kieseritzky Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Nf3

006 **Center Game: Kieseritzky Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Nf3 c5

007 **Center Game: Kieseritzky Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Nf3 c5 4. Bc4

008 **Center Game: Lanc-Arnold Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Nf3 Bc5 4. c3

009 **Center Game: Lanc-Arnold Gambit, Schippler Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Nf3 Bc5 4. c3 dxc3 5. Bc4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C21 line

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010 Center Game: Ross Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Bd3

011 Center Game: von der Lasa Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. Bc4

012 Danish Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3

013 Danish Gambit Accepted

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 dxc3

014 Danish Gambit Accepted: Chigorin Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Bc4 cxb2 5. Bxb2 Qe7

015 Danish Gambit Accepted: Classical Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Bc4 cxb2 5. Bxb2 Nf6

016 Danish Gambit Accepted: Copenhagen Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Bc4 cxb2 5. Bxb2 Bb4+

017 Danish Gambit Accepted: Schlechter Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 dxc3 4. Bc4 cxb2 5. Bxb2 d5

018 Danish Gambit Accepted: Svenonius Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 Ne7

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C21 line

This section preserves all 19 names and defining routes assigned to C21 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 Danish Gambit Declined: Sørensen Defense

1. e4 e5 2. d4 exd4 3. c3 d5